

Recipe Website UI Style Guide

DARK MODE IMPLEMENTATION SPECIFICATIONS

This design system document establishes the dark mode overrides, visual hierarchy, and night-view interface rules for the culinary platform. It adapts the core light palette into a warm, low-strain canvas designed for dim kitchen conditions.

1. Dark Mode Color Tokens

Rather than using cold digital blacks, these tokens rely on warm espresso bases to keep food photography looking natural and appetizing.

Primary Base (Dark)

Hex: #1E1B18

Role: Main body viewport, underlying background canvas.

Secondary (Muted Sage)

Hex: #A2A45C

Role: Low-strain typography links, active UI lines, category tags.

Tertiary (Ochre Accent)

Hex: #D4A373

Role: Conversion buttons, primary call-to-actions.

2. Dark Mode Media Queries & CSS Properties

Please implement these token overrides within the local user preference stylesheets:

```
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  :root {
    /* Color Token Overrides */
    --color-primary-base: #1E1B18;
    --color-secondary-sage: #A2A45C;
    --color-tertiary-ochre: #D4A373;
    --color-text-main: #FAF6F0;
    --color-text-muted: #B5AD9E;
    --color-surface-white: #2A2622;
    --color-surface-card-border: #3A352F;
  }
}
```

3. Component Dark Implementation

This table lists structural mapping adaptations required for components in dark rendering mode.

Component	Dark State Strategy	Visual Asset Preview
Primary Buttons	Retains the ochre color but flips text color to #1E1B18 for high-contrast accessibility against deep backdrops.	PRINT RECIPE
Dietary Badges	Utilizes the slightly desaturated sage (#A2A45C) to stop text glowing on dark displays.	VEGAN
Recipe Grid Cards	Instead of true white, blocks map to a soft dark warm-brown layer (#2A2622) bordered by a muted trim.	Classic Lemon Tart Prep: 20 mins • Serves 8

4. Critical Developer Accessibility Guidelines

Guideline A: Preventing Blue/Green Neon Glow

Standard high-contrast greens cause heavy eye strain on black screens. The adjusted sage token (#A2A45C) has had its intensity reduced by 10% to look natural, soft, and balanced next to dark text blocks.

Guideline B: Soft Surface Layering

Do not allow card outlines to drop out or turn stark white. Use #3A352F to create subtle boundaries around individual recipes, review inputs, and secondary search widgets.

Guideline C: Typography Adaptations

All standard header elements and body strings swap to a crisp, readable linen tint (#FAF6F0). Secondary data points (e.g., cooking timers, ratings) must inherit #B5AD9E to ensure correct content weight hierarchy.